

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 220 · HOT

Anduril Industries

Defence Technology · Autonomous Systems / Lattice Software · Costa Mesa, California (founded 2017) · Private (\$61B; \$5B Series H, May 2026)

Anduril, the Costa Mesa defence-technology company that already sponsors NASCAR and Hendrick Motorsports, announced a \$5B Series H at a \$61B valuation on 13 May 2026, doubling its price in a year, weeks before its first NASCAR title race and the start of production at its \$1B Ohio factory.

79

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

On 13 May 2026 Anduril announced a \$5B Series H led by Thrive Capital and Andreessen Horowitz at a \$61B valuation, double the \$30.5B set in June 2025, taking total funding past \$11B over eight rounds. The demand behind it is public: the US Army awarded a ten-year enterprise contract with a \$20B ceiling on 13 March 2026, and Arsenal-1, a \$1B factory in Columbus, Ohio, targets production from July. Anduril has bought motorsport already: Official Defense Partner of NASCAR, title sponsor of June's San Diego weekend at Naval Base Coronado, and Hendrick's William Byron through 2028.

That NASCAR programme is the tell. A company that put a Cup Series event on a naval base to recruit engineers and tell a rebuild-the-arsenal story has a template Formula 1 can scale: three US rounds, a global engineering audience and a listing expected in 2027. General Motors is the bridge. GM Defense signed a teaming agreement with Anduril in October 2023 on autonomy and electrification, and Cadillac is GM's works team.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 13 May; the NASCAR debut at Coronado is in June and Arsenal-1 starts production in July, so budget, motorsport template and manufacturing story crest together. The United States GP in Austin (October) and the Las Vegas GP (November) fall inside the window; 2027 rosters close in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$5B

\$5B Series H at a \$61B valuation, announced 13 May 2026, led by Thrive Capital and Andreessen Horowitz; tot...

\$2.5B

Thrive Capital and Andreessen Horowitz (returning leads); the prior round was \$2.5B at a \$30.5B valuation i...

\$20B

The demand behind it is public: the US Army awarded a ten-year enterprise contract with a \$20B ceiling on 1...

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Cadillac F1 Team	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Oracle Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Scuderia Ferrari HP	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A \$5B round at \$61B, a \$20B Army contract ceiling, a factory starting in July and a NASCAR programme already running put Anduril at peak brand-investment authority with a proven appetite for motorsport. GM Defense gives a warm path into Cadillac, the defence lane on the grid is open and two US races remain inside the window.

FUNDING EVENT

MOTORSPORT PRECEDENT

PARTNER ADJACENCY

DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac is General Motors' American works entry, in its first season with a deliberately small roster: TWG AI, Core Scientific, IFS, Tenneco, Jim Beam, Tommy Hilfiger, Claro. No aerospace, defence or autonomy partner is on it, and the parent already works with Anduril through GM Defense, so the introduction is warm on both sides. Three US rounds give a Costa Mesa brand home stages, and a debut team prices entry below the established grid.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - halo with concrete mechanics. TWG AI holds Cadillac's exclusive AI lane, so this is not a software workstream. It is: livery and garage presence at Miami, Austin and Las Vegas; engineering-recruitment content, the job Anduril's marketing chief says marketing does, filmed at Arsenal-1 and the team's Indiana headquarters; warfighter-family programmes carried over from the Hendrick deal; hospitality for Pentagon, Congressional and allied guests at the US rounds.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Defence Technology Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, bridging the Hendrick term and a probable listing. Estimated \$8-12M a year, the top of Cadillac's partner tier. Scope: engine-cover or rear-wing placement, US-round hospitality, recruitment and manufacturing content, a joint GM Defense and Cadillac engineering story.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Jeff Miller

CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, ANDURIL INDUSTRIES · **VERIFIED**

Anduril's first marketing chief, hired in May 2024 from Cruise, where he was VP of marketing, after Snapchat, PepsiCo and Ogilvy; he built the NASCAR and Hendrick programmes. Path: Matthew Steckman, President and Chief Business Officer; Matt Grimm, Co-Founder and COO; Brian Schimpf, CEO.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the NASCAR template.

“Jeff, you put a Cup Series event on a naval base. Formula 1 gives you Austin, Las Vegas and Miami, a global engineering audience, and GM's own works team, whose parent already works with you. 25 minutes before Austin to size the Cadillac lane?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 18 / 20 Round 13 May; NASCAR debut June; Arsenal-1 July; Austin and Las Vegas in window.	CAPACITY 20 / 20 \$5B raise at \$61B; more than \$11B raised; \$20B Army contract ceiling.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 Proven motorsport buyer; American engineering story; defence sensitivities.	URGENCY 14 / 20 Listing expected 2027; 2027 rosters close in Q4; Hendrick term runs to 2028.	OPS FIT 12 / 20 MODE B: halo with recruitment and US-round mechanics; AI lane held by TWG.
--	---	--	---	---

RISKS & COUNTERS

BRAND SAFETY A weapons maker on a Formula 1 car will draw scrutiny from teams, promoters and a European fan base NASCAR did not test. **Counter:** Lead with the Boeing-at-Alpine precedent and Cadillac's American identity; agree product-imagery rules up front.

CATEGORY DEFINITION TWG AI is Cadillac's exclusive AI partner and Anduril's Lattice is AI software; the lane must be defence technology, not AI. **Counter:** Define the lane as defence and autonomous systems and clear it with TWG before the first call.

SOURCES — 15 OF 15 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://www.odwyerpr.com/story/public/21267/2024-05-15/move-anduril-names-miller-first-marketing-chief.html
- https://techcrunch.com/2026/05/13/anduril-raises-5b-doubles-valuation-to-61b/
- https://www.hendrickmotorsports.com/news/2025/10/22/anduril-joins-hendrick-motorsports-primary-nascar-sponsor-william-byron-through-2028
- https://www.gmdefensellc.com/site/us/en/gm-defense/home/news-and-events/news.detail.html/Pages/news/us/en/2023/oct/1010-gmdefense.html
- https://www.army.mil/article/291074/u_s_army_awards_enterprise_contract_for_it_commercial_solutions
- https://breakingdefense.com/2025/01/anduril-picks-columbus-for-new-arsenal-factory-targets-july-2026-to-begin-production/